

# Hot Technologies From A Cloud Country

Looking at the world map, it seems that Russia is far, far away to the North. So, ask an ordinary person about Russia and the response would probably involve “winter, military weaponry and oil”. However, Russia also has a strong Linux development experience. Read on to learn more.



When GNU/Linux was new, it began to attract the attention of technical specialists in Russia in the second half of the 90s, because of its excellent networking capabilities and the incomparable productivity level—Linux could run on hardware like an Intel DX486 with 8 MB RAM quite easily. Besides, you could have several simultaneous Internet sessions of *lynx*, or the links browser, as well as a text session in *mcedit/vi/joe*; plus, you could at the same time do some programming exercises with EGCS. Should I mention that such operations were available in a live-mode, started off from a usual floppy-disk, though in text mode? The same productivity level wasn't possible with Microsoft Windows 3.11, 95 or NT 4.0 even on a higher level of hardware like Intel Pentium, with 32 MB RAM and 1 GB HDD.

Moreover, if you had experience with Linux back then, you were guaranteed to be able to work either with your local machine, or with very distant UNIX-based hosts (for example, Solaris or FreeBSD) outside the country at an equally productivity level. SSH protocol allowed you to perform such operations quite easily. In addition, a very compact size, great performance and tremendous opportunities of the system (Linux) in general added more kudos to it. One of the opportunities I mentioned was MP3-playback via a normal PC speaker. Such simple tasks were hardly possible with other operating systems those days; besides, you had a real presentation about Linux—what it could do!

The important fact was that Linux was initially created with classical UNIX-style in